

Two hundred billion ghouls erupted from the gate. They had been trapped within the labyrinth for untold eons, waiting for the gate to open. Many of the ghouls fell immediately to the suns light, but the more stalwart among them persevered til the sun set. These ghouls were hailed as the “Great Ghouls” from then on. The Great Ghouls cast cool, dark shadows, bearing the suns vilest rays so the weakest ghouls might survive. For this act the Great Ghouls were hailed as martyrs, leaders, and even gods. Crowds of ghouls surrounded the Great Ghouls, dancing in gay festivity, praying in screeches and scraws.

The peace and joy of the ghouls could only last so long, however, and after a century of pleasant times a great bird came down upon the ghouls. This bird, known as the Dark-Abzud, devoured swathes of ghouls with its sweeping beak. The Great Ghouls, sun-slowed, could do nothing to stop the Dark-Abzud’s feeding. The weakest ghouls fell to despair, then despondence, then resentment; eventually, they gathered an army strong enough to challenge the Great Ghouls. Before the army could reach the Great Ghouls, however, a stylish ghoul caught their attention. This ghoul, clad in business formal and carrying a suitcase, recited a convincing speech. Every ghoul that listened saw them self in the business-ghoul, and recited the speech all across ghoultopia. Come the next morning, the army had crumbled and a league of business-ghouls had arisen.

In secret, after delivering their speech, the first business-ghoul slithered through the shadowy earth to find the realm of the dead, where it rendezvoused with the father of the Dark-Abzud, the Light-Abzud.